



TODAY, WE'RE LEARNING FROM THE LAUNCH

Kevin's Natural Foods Stir-Fry Portfolio Review Analysis

Launch-to-current evidence across 13 products and seven retail channels

BOTTOM LINE Consumer feedback points to a two-speed portfolio: grocery kits carry materially weaker ratings and more low-star reviews than Costco-only items. Recent first-party feedback is softer than launch, with the most actionable pressure centered on taste, portion/value, and protein-to-vegetable balance.

3.04 vs 4.19 AVG. WRITTEN RATING Grocery vs Costco-only	43.8% vs 16.7% 1-2 STAR SHARE Grocery vs Costco-only	4.71 to 2.75 GROCERY FIRST-PARTY Launch 6m to recent 6m	166 UNIQUE WRITTEN REVIEWS 278 channel ratings
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Business objective

Establish a launch-to-current consumer read across the 13 specified stir-fry products, identify emerging experience gaps, and define where product, pack, channel, and operational follow-up can create the most value. **The six grocery kits and seven Costco-only items remain separate cohorts.**

What the evidence shows

- Honey Garlic Chicken Kit** 54 reviews | 3.13 overall | 2.40 recent Largest evidence base; 53% recent low-star
- General Tso's Chicken Kit** 24 reviews | 2.54 overall 58% low-star; weakest scaled grocery experience
- Chicken Fajitas Kit** 30 reviews | 3.20 overall | 2.60 recent 53% recent low-star; portion/value prominent
- Portfolio split:** Grocery kits average 3.04 stars with 43.8% low-star reviews versus 4.19 and 16.7% for Costco-only items; this is not a controlled cohort comparison.
- Complaint mix:** Among low-star reviews, taste leads (34 mentions), followed by portion/value (28), vegetables (23), texture (11), packaging (10), and protein quantity (9).

Five provocations for the business

- Is the 2.5-serving promise creating an expectation gap?** 41 of 112 grocery-kit reviews mention portion/value; 16 specifically flag protein quantity. Test pack communication and protein-to-vegetable balance.
- Did the grocery-kit experience weaken as distribution scaled?** The complete first-party history moves from 4.71 (n=7) at launch to 2.75 (n=12) recently. Validate against lots, promotions, and channel mix.
- The early Costco baseline is not a clean launch benchmark.** All 16 reviews carrying a disclosed future-purchase incentive badge were 5-star and concentrated early; do not treat the rating gap as like-for-like.
- Convenience appears to be an equity worth protecting.** It appears in 69 of 166 reviews. Preserve the fast, low-mess preparation benefit while addressing the food experience.
- Use retailer variance as a learning agenda, not a scorecard.** Target and Kroger populations and syndication differ; connect channel results with price, promotion, and review-origin metadata.

Immediate next moves

- Prioritize Honey Garlic, General Tso's, and Chicken Fajitas grocery kits; include the recent Beef & Broccoli Costco signal as a targeted watch item.
- Test portion architecture, protein/vegetable balance, and pack communication; connect the findings with consumer care, returns, lot/supplier records, promotions, and price.
- Fill sparse exact-SKU histories through retailer or syndication exports. Amazon was searched for all six grocery kits, but no exact scoped page was confirmed; this is not a zero-review claim.

EVIDENCE GUARDRAIL 202 raw written rows were reconciled to 166 unique reviews after removing 36 cross-source duplicates: 81 first-party, 56 incremental Target, and 29 incremental Kroger. The 278 channel rating observations are kept separate from written-review trends. Retailer populations and syndication rules differ; review language identifies where to investigate, not manufacturing causality.

Interactive dashboard: mars-fn-innovation-prototypes.github.io/knf-beef-review-dashboard/stir-fry.html